

MiniLicensePlates.com

Publish local changes to production — FileZilla & cPanel (no SSH)

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Live site: <https://minilicenseplates.com>

How you deploy: GitHub Desktop on your PC (save work to GitHub) + **FileZilla** (upload changed files to the server). You do **not** need SSH, Terminal, or `git pull` on the server.

Never upload from your PC: `.env` (server has its own), `public/plates/` (already on server), or `mlp_code/`.

Your FileZilla setup (from your account)

Item	Value
Host	ftp.minilicenseplates.com
Username	chuck@minilicenseplates.com
Local project (left pane)	d:\aamlpproj
Remote home (right pane)	/ (root)
Laravel app on server	/new.minilicenseplates.com/ — open this folder; it should contain app, resources, routes, public, etc.
Main web folder	/public_html/ — browsers load minilicenseplates.com from here
CSS on live site	https://minilicenseplates.com/main.css → upload to /public_html/main.css
JS on live site	https://minilicenseplates.com/js/... → upload to /public_html/js/

Two folders — both may matter

- `/new.minilicenseplates.com/` — upload Laravel code here (app/, resources/, config/, routes/, database/). Plate photos (if any new ones) go in `public/plates/` under this folder.
- `/public_html/` — the live site at **minilicenseplates.com** loads static assets from here: `main.css`, `js/`, banner images, `index.php`, etc. Always upload changed CSS/JS/images here (see Step 5).

Confirmed: The live site loads CSS from <https://minilicenseplates.com/main.css>. After every style change, upload local `public/main.css` to remote `/public_html/main.css` (overwrite). Laravel PHP/views still go under `/new.minilicenseplates.com/`.

Before you start

- ☐ Site works on `http://localhost:8000` (XAMPP MySQL running, `php artisan serve`)
- ☐ FileZilla is installed and you can connect to your hosting account
- ☐ You know if this update adds **new database tables/columns** (migrations)
- ☐ You know if this update adds **new PHP packages** (e.g. DomPDF in `composer.json`)

Step-by-step (no SSH)

1 Review changes in GitHub Desktop

Open GitHub Desktop for `aamlpproj`. Check the changed files list. Typical uploads: `public/main.css`, `public/js/`, `resources/views/`, `app/`, `config/`, `routes/web.php`, `database/migrations/` (if new). Do not commit `.env` or plate images.

2 Commit and push (backup on GitHub)

Write a short commit message →

Commit to main

→

Push origin

. This keeps a copy on GitHub; the live site is updated in the next steps by FileZilla, not by push alone.

3 Connect FileZilla

Site Manager → host `ftp.minilicenseplates.com`, user `chuck@minilicenseplates.com`. On the **right (Remote)**

, open `/new.minilicenseplates.com/` for Laravel code uploads. Keep `/public_html/` in mind for CSS/JS/images the browser loads directly.

4 Upload Laravel code (PHP, views, config, routes, migrations)

Left pane: d:\aamlpproj. Right pane: /new.minilicenseplates.com/. Drag changed files to the *same relative path* on the server:

- Local app/... → Remote /new.minilicenseplates.com/app/...
- Local resources/views/... → Remote /new.minilicenseplates.com/resources/views/...
- Local config/... → Remote /new.minilicenseplates.com/config/...
- Local routes/web.php → Remote /new.minilicenseplates.com/routes/web.php
- Local database/migrations/... → Remote /new.minilicenseplates.com/database/migrations/...

CSS, JS, and images are

not

served from this folder on the live site — upload those in Step 5 to /public_html/. When FileZilla asks to overwrite, choose

Overwrite

.

5 Upload CSS and JS to public_html (required for styles & scripts)

The live site uses the site root, not /public/ in the URL:

- d:\aamlpproj\public\main.css → /public_html/main.css
(always, when CSS changed)
- d:\aamlpproj\public\js\ → /public_html/js/ (create js folder if needed)
- Banner images (home_top_banner.jpg, blue_back_composite_img_sm.jpg, etc.) → /public_html/
- Custom rotator images in public/hero/ → /public_html/hero/
- New placeholder image public/plate_missing.png → /public_html/plate_missing.png

Live URLs use the site root — e.g. <https://minilicenseplates.com/main.css>,
<https://minilicenseplates.com/js/home-hero.js> — never /public/ in the path.

6 New PHP packages (only if composer.json changed)

On your PC, in PowerShell from d:\aamlpproj, run:

```
composer install --no-dev
```

Then upload the entire remote vendor/ folder from your PC to the server's vendor/ folder via FileZilla. This can take several minutes. Skip if you only changed CSS, views, or PHP that uses packages already on the server.

7 New database migrations (only if new files in database/migrations/)

Without Terminal/SSH, you have two practical options:

- **Ask your host**

to run `php artisan migrate --force` once in your app folder (many hosts will do this on request).

- **cPanel Cron Jobs**

(one time): if your host allows Cron, add a job that runs once: `php /full/path/to/your/app/artisan migrate --force`, then remove the cron job after it runs.

Upload the new migration `.php` files to `/new.minilicenseplates.com/database/migrations/` on the server in either case. Do not rebuild tables manually in phpMyAdmin unless you know the exact SQL.

Example cron command (path may vary — ask your host): `php`

`/home/chuck/new.minilicenseplates.com/artisan migrate --force`

8 Clear cached views (optional, if pages look wrong)

In cPanel

File Manager

(or FileZilla), under `/new.minilicenseplates.com/`, open `bootstrap/cache/` and delete any `.php` files there (keep `.gitignore`). Also delete files in `storage/framework/views/` if Blade templates still look stale. No command line needed.

9 Do not replace production .env

The server has its own `.env` with database password and `APP_URL=https://minilicenseplates.com`. Never upload your local `.env` over it.

10 Test the live site

Open <https://minilicenseplates.com> and press

Ctrl+F5

(hard refresh). Check pages you changed. Try sign-in, admin, gallery, and collection if those areas were updated.

11 If something breaks — rollback

- Re-upload the previous version of the broken file(s) from GitHub Desktop (History → right-click file → Reveal in Explorer, or checkout an older commit locally and upload those files).
- Keep a copy of `main.css` on the server before overwriting (FileZilla: download backup first).

If you are publishing the latest local work, these paths are commonly involved (upload Laravel paths to /new.minilicenseplates.com/; CSS/JS to /public_html/):

Feature	Key local paths
Home hero rotator	config/home_hero.php, resources/views/components/home-hero-rotator.blade.php, public/js/home-hero.js, public/main.css
Admin CMS (users, newsletter, catalog)	app/Http/Controllers/Admin/, resources/views/admin/, routes/web.php, config/admin.php
Member collection & sign-in	app/Http/Controllers/Auth/, app/Http/Controllers/CollectionController.php, resources/views/collection/, resources/views/auth/
Session bar (log out, admin pill)	resources/views/components/header.blade.php, public/main.css
Admin DB fields	database/migrations/2026_05_26_140000_add_admin_fields_to_users_table.php — then run migrate (Step 7)

What goes where (your server)

On your PC (d:\aamlpproj)	Upload to on server
app/, config/, resources/, routes/, database/	/new.minilicenseplates.com/ (same subfolders)
public/main.css, public/js/, images	/public_html/ (live URL: /main.css, /js/...)
vendor/ (after local composer install)	/new.minilicenseplates.com/vendor/
public/plates/	Only if you added new photos locally → /new.minilicenseplates.com/public/plates/ (large folder — already on server)
.env	Never upload — server keeps its own

What NOT to do

- Do not use SSH or Terminal — not required.
- new.minilicenseplates.com on the server is a **folder name**, not your live URL. The live site is **minilicenseplates.com**.
- Do not upload .env from your PC (visible in FileZilla local list — skip it).

Local test before deploy

```
cd d:\aamlpproj  
php artisan serve
```

Open <http://localhost:8000>. Start MySQL in XAMPP first.